



DSLR Cameras

Smartphone cameras have long since displaced the point-n-shoot as the camera of choice for most scenarios, but the image quality of a DSLR is yet to be matched by any digital imaging product so far, at least, as far as consumers are concerned.

DSLRs offer unmatched shooting speeds and clarity, when paired with some degree of skill and the right lenses, and while a novice might be intimidated by the sheer size of a DSLR and the plethora of controls on offer, it's actually not that bad once you get started. If you're serious about photography, or just want better photographs, spending a little over 20K is all you really need to pick up an entry-level DSLR.

Zero1 winner

Canon 5D Mark III

For a two year old camera to win Zero1 is unusual, but it's testament to the quality of the camera that it stands up to brand new cameras launched today. It's missing out on features, most notably in the video department, but it's a blazing-fast camera with fast



Nikon D810

Price: ₹1,81,000 (Body)



Canon 1200D

Price: ₹25,000 (with 18-55mm IS II lens)



Nikon D3300

Price: ₹28,000 (with 18-55mm VR II lens)



▲ CANON 5D MARK III

Price: ₹1,90,000 (Body)

auto-focus, excellent low-light performance and accurate white-balance.

On a purely, shall we say, clinical level, the camera offers less detail than the D810 and is also just a bit more aggressive with its noise reduction on default settings, but that's like saying that a Ferrari accelerates from 0-100 in 5 seconds as opposed to 4.8 seconds on a Lambo. The difference doesn't matter unless you're hell-bent on extracting the very last pixel of detail from an image, regardless of noise.

That said, it's important to note that while this camera is better than the D810, it's so very slightly ahead that it's only of academic importance. Only a photographer who really knows what he wants can pick between the 5D Mark III and the D810.

Runner Up Nikon D810

The D810 is Nikon's latest entrant into the full-frame DSLR space and it is a fantastic camera. The only reason it's falling behind the 5D Mark III, and even then, only by 0.5 points, is that the noise gets a little more noticeable as you increase ISO, requiring more aggressive noise reduction at those levels.

The camera does feature a much lower ISO of 64, which should make a world of a difference in studio photography, because the camera is incredibly sharp. We could very clearly observe even the texture of the SpyderCUBE that we use for calibrating our images; the amount of detail in the texture was not visible on any other camera or any other ISO, even on the D810.

While the 5D Mark III is the winner, the D810 might still be the more feature-rich option.

Worthy mentions

Canon 1200D

This makes for a great camera if you're just starting out in photography. It's got a lot of features, though slightly less so than its Nikon counterpart, and can boast of image quality that is excellent. It's not a 5D Mark III but as an entry-level camera, it's perfect. Throw on a 50mm f/1.8 lens and you have a superb photography tool at your disposal.

Nikon D3300

This camera lagged behind the 1200D in terms of image sharpness and colour tone, but the difference was only slight. It offers more features including a noticeably higher ISO range and better noise control at higher ISOs, but the loss in sharpness is still an issue. Regardless, if it's a Nikon camera that you want, you can't go wrong with this one; and it's not that much worse than the 1200D anyway. **4**